

SHALINI MADAN

PhD Student in Information Science | Human-AI Interaction & Accessibility

School of Information · University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

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EDUCATION

- PhD in Information Science** Aug 2026 – May 2031 (expected)
University of Michigan, School of Information Ann Arbor, MI
• **Advisor:** Dr. Venkatesh Potluri | **Lab Affiliation:** IDEA Lab
- M.S. in Information Science (Concentration in Human-Computer Interaction)** May 2026
University of Michigan, School of Information Ann Arbor, MI
• **Thesis:** Accessibility Heuristics for Vibe Coding Interfaces
• **Committee:** Dr. Venkatesh Potluri, Dr. Steve Oney
- B.Des. in Interaction Design** 2020 – 2024
PES University Bangalore, India
• **Relevant Coursework:** Advanced Interaction Design Studio, UX Research Methods, Web Design & Development, Cognitive Ergonomics, Conversational UX Design
• **Honors:** Prof. MRD Scholarship, Distinction Award Certificates

PUBLICATIONS

- [3] **Madan, S.**, Surabiyil Bindu, S., Pimenova, V., Seehorn, E., & Potluri, V. (2026, October). Reflections and recommendations on AI adoption practice from a mixed-ability research group. In *Proceedings of the 28th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '26)*.
- [2] **Madan, S.**, Surabiyil Bindu, S., & Potluri, V. (2026, April). Vibe check: Accessibility heuristics for vibe coding interfaces. In *Proceedings of the 23rd International Web for All Conference (W4A '26, pp. 229–241)*.
★ **Best Technical Paper Nominee**
- [1] **Madan, S.**, Surabiyil Bindu, S., & Potluri, V. (2025, October). Accessibility Heuristics for Vibe Coding Interfaces. In *Proceedings of the 27th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '25, pp. 1–5)*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Master's Thesis Student Researcher & Graduate Researcher** May 2025 – Present
IDEA Lab, School of Information, University of Michigan Ann Arbor, MI
Advisor: Dr. Venkatesh Potluri
• Developed empirical heuristic-based evaluation methods to assess the accessibility of vibe and agentic coding tools for Blind and Low-Vision (BLV) users.
• Conducted 18 qualitative interviews with assistive technology users and accessibility professionals to identify usability barriers and inform heuristic refinement.
• Led qualitative coding, descriptive statistical analysis, study protocol design, IRB documentation management, and participant recruitment.
- Independent Study Researcher** Dec 2024 – Mar 2025
University of Michigan Ann Arbor, MI
Advisor: Dr. Venkatesh Potluri
• Synthesized literature on how BLV communities interact with GenAI platforms, IDEs, and programming tools.
• Designed and executed an autoethnographic study examining screen-reader users building conversational AI agents via low- and no-code interfaces.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Instructor — SI 552: Introduction to Accessibility

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

School of Information, University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

- Contributed to designing and implementing a competency-based assessment framework and comprehensive syllabus redesign.
- Supported core lectures for 40 students; led grading, provided in-depth technical feedback, held office hours, and mentored final projects in inclusive design.

Graduate Student Instructor — SI 539: Responsive Web Design & Accessibility

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

School of Information, University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

- Led weekly discussion sections for 12 students and created revision resources for accessible web development using HTML, CSS, and JS modules.
- Assisted main lectures for 80 students, authored concise "revision sheets" to reinforce syntax concepts, and evaluated final project work.

Graduate Instructional Aide — SI 552: Introduction to Accessibility

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

School of Information, University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

- Supported course logistics, designed accessible lecture materials, and coordinated student progress tracking and evaluation processes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX & Accessibility Research Intern

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Harvard University – Harvard Library

Cambridge, MA

- Conducted accessibility-centered usability evaluations of the Mirador image-viewing platform to enhance discoverability for low-vision users.
- Evaluated library-wide accessibility auditing practices and performed contextual inquiries to streamline digital archive workflows.
- Migrated and standardized 100+ repository records, improving metadata accuracy; audited and fact-checked 100 LLM-generated summaries.

UX Designer (Internship)

May 2023 – May 2024

UST Evolve – Moonraft Innovation Labs

Bangalore, India

- Architected a service blueprint for an ESG consulting platform by mapping stakeholder pain points and analyzing industry sustainability gaps.
- Executed mixed-method UX research (interviews, surveys, contextual inquiries) resulting in 100% client conversion from pilot to long-term engagements.

Product Design Intern

Jan 2023 – May 2023

Hurray Tech Ventures Pvt Ltd

Bangalore, India

- Led field research with 20+ educators in government schools to prototype an inclusive AI learning platform, directly securing project deployment expansion.

Product Design Intern

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Aknamed Pvt Ltd (A PharmEasy Company)

Bangalore, India

- Redesigned B2B procurement dashboard and established a cohesive design system, boosting dashboard engagement by 30%.

FUNDING, GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

UMSI Graduate Teaching Assistantship (\$85,000)

2025 – 2026

UMSI Student Travel Grant (\$1,000)

2025 – 2026

UMSI Student Travel Grant (\$1,000)

2024 – 2025

Conference Attendance Scholarship (\$750)

May 2025

Prof. MRD Tuition Fee Waiver (50% Tuition Refund)

Jan 2023

AWARDS & HONORS

Best Technical Paper Nominee	23rd Web for All Conference (W4A)	Apr 2026
Rising Fledgling (Nominee)	UST Evolve – Moonraft Innovation Labs	Dec 2023
Designer of the Month	UST Evolve – Moonraft Innovation Labs	Jul 2023
Distinction Award Certificates	PES University	2020 – 2024

ACADEMIC SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Student Volunteer	Oct 2025
<i>ACM SIGACCESS ASSETS 2025</i>	Denver, CO
• Coordinated conference accessibility logistics and attendee support for an international HCI and accessibility research venue.	
Inclusive Leader in Information	2024 – 2025
<i>UMSI – Student Life Partnership, University of Michigan</i>	Ann Arbor, MI
• Equipped with leadership skills to foster equity, peer participation, and accessibility inclusion across the UMSI community.	
Peer Mentor & Invited Panelist	2025 – 2026
<i>School of Information, University of Michigan</i>	Ann Arbor, MI
• Invited speaker for the UMSI International Student Panel (Aug 2025), addressing over 100 first-year students on first-generation graduate student experiences.	
• Mentored peers during UMSI Peer Internship events on UX research recruiting and academic career pathways.	
Founder & Community Volunteer	2016 – 2024
<i>Give India for Voiceless (Animal Welfare NGO)</i>	Bangalore, India
• Led vaccination drives, managed medical treatment funding, and organized volunteer networks for stray animal rescue and care.	